

Credit Card Customer Churn Prediction Pipeline

End-to-End ML Solution on AWS using Apache Spark

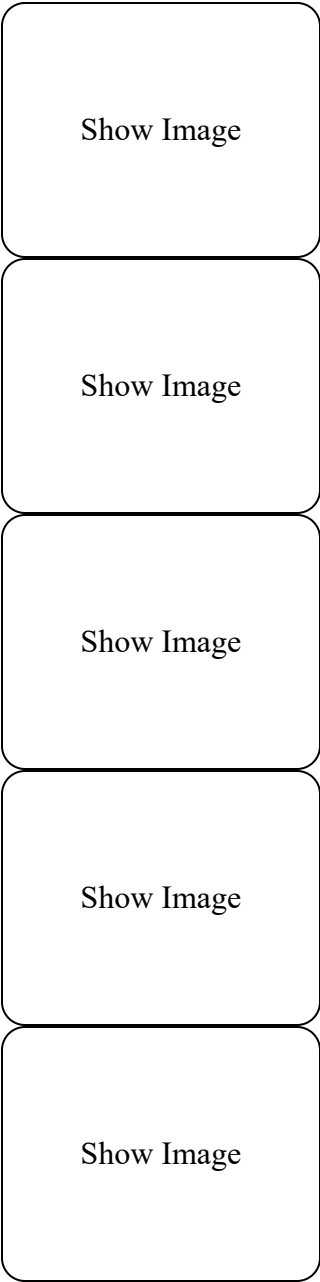


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Project Overview

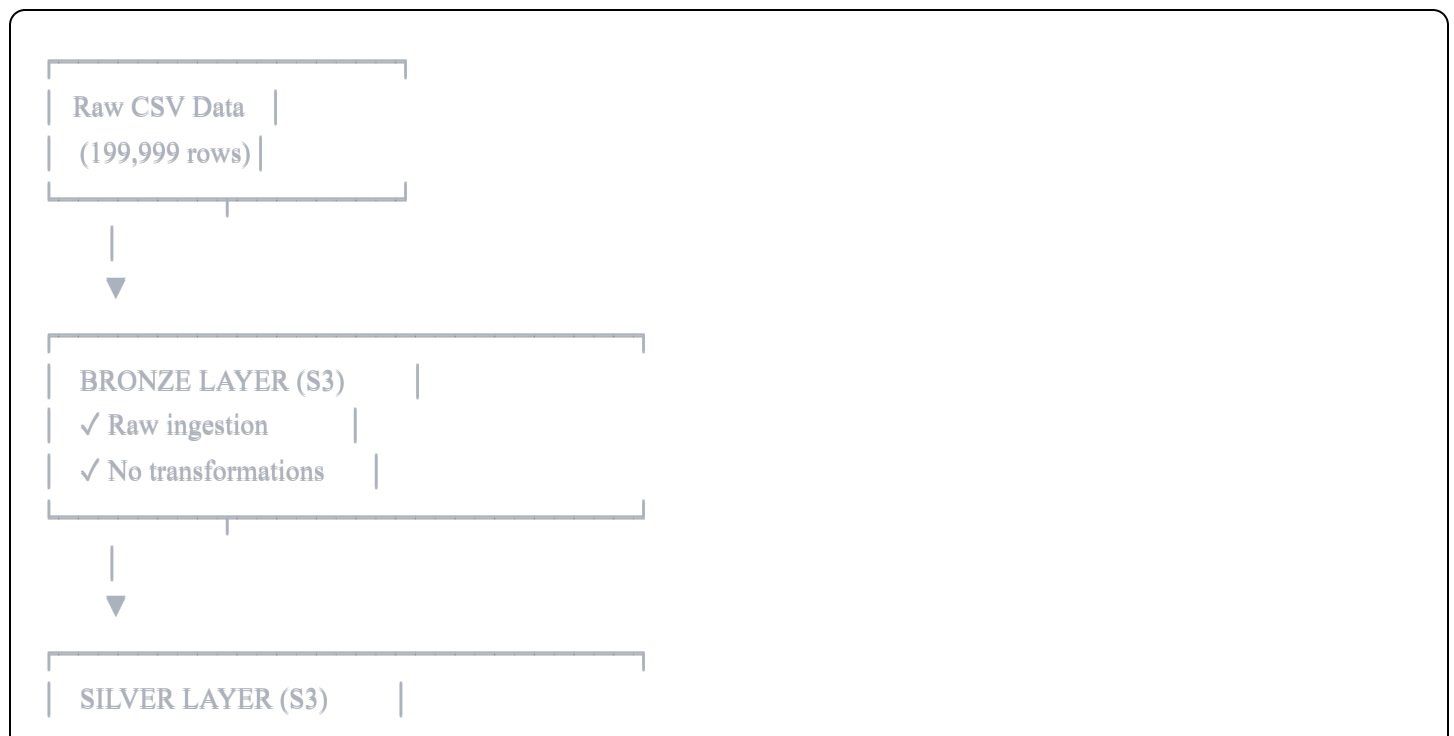
Built a production-grade machine learning pipeline to predict credit card customer churn using the **Medallion Architecture** on AWS. The pipeline processes 200K+ customer records, achieving **80% AUC-ROC** with Random Forest classification.

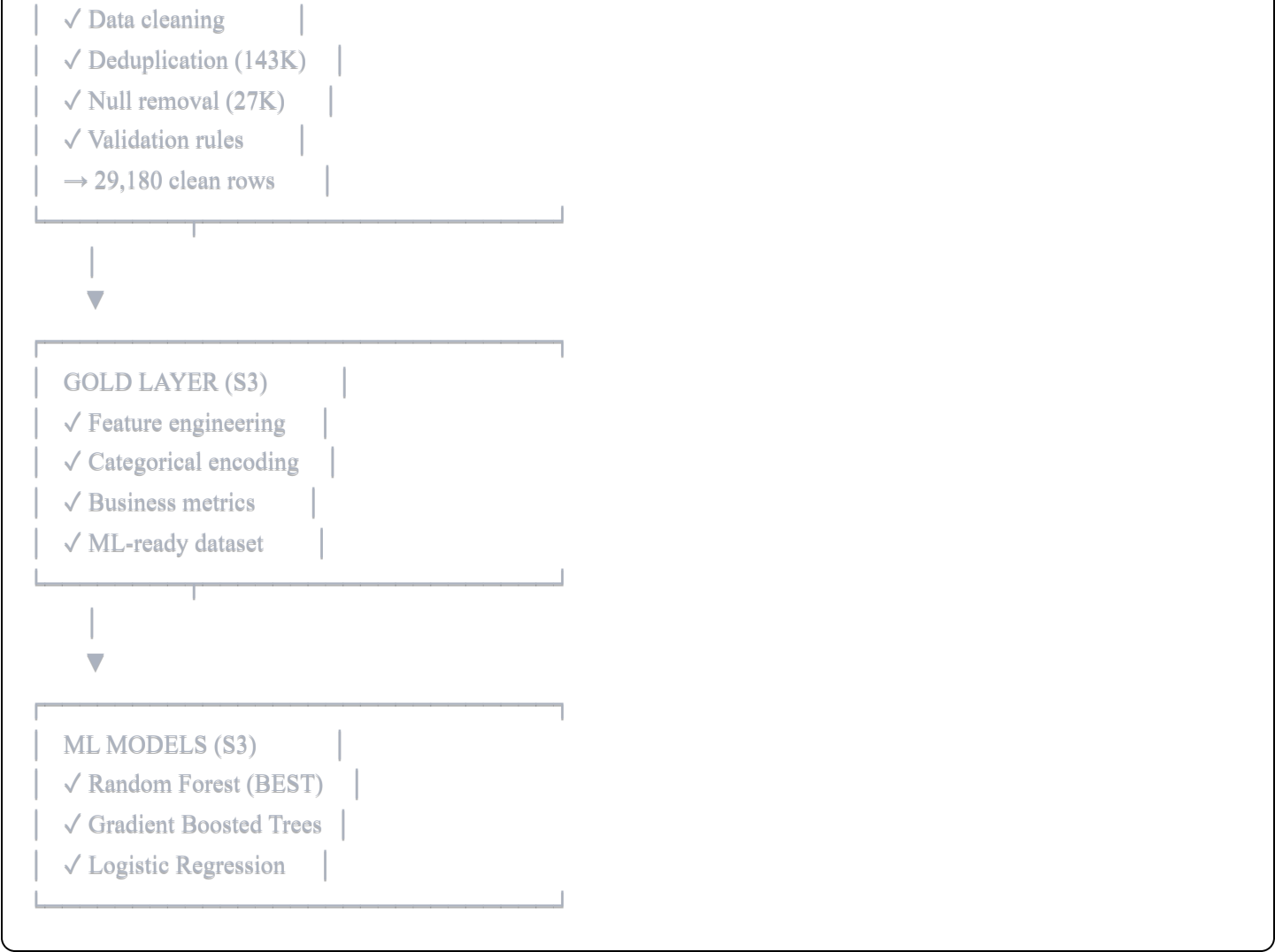
Problem Statement: Credit card companies lose significant revenue when customers churn. Early identification of at-risk customers enables proactive retention strategies.

Solution: Scalable ETL pipeline + ML model that identifies churners with 75.76% accuracy, enabling targeted retention campaigns.

Architecture

Medallion Architecture (Bronze → Silver → Gold)





Technology Stack

Cloud & Infrastructure

- **AWS S3:** Data lake storage (Bronze/Silver/Gold layers)
- **AWS IAM:** Secure access management
- **Apache Spark 3.5:** Distributed data processing
- **PySpark:** Python API for Spark

Machine Learning

- **Spark MLlib:** Scalable ML algorithms
- **Random Forest:** Best performing model (AUC: 0.80)
- **Gradient Boosted Trees:** Alternative ensemble method

- **Logistic Regression:** Baseline model

Development Tools

- **Python 3.10:** Core programming language
 - **Java 17:** Required for Spark runtime
 - **Hadoop 3.3.4:** Distributed file system support
 - **Git:** Version control
-

🌟 Key Features

Data Engineering

- ☒ **Scalable ETL Pipeline:** Processes 200K+ records efficiently
- ☒ **Data Quality:** 72% duplicate/null removal for clean analysis
- ☒ **Feature Engineering:** 6 derived features for ML
- ☒ **Parquet Format:** Columnar storage for optimized queries

Machine Learning

- ☒ **Multi-Model Training:** Compared 3 different algorithms
- ☒ **Cross-Validation:** 80/20 train-test split
- ☒ **Feature Importance:** Identified top churn drivers
- ☒ **Production Ready:** Serialized model saved to S3

Best Practices

- ☒ **Medallion Architecture:** Industry-standard data layering
 - ☒ **Cloud-Native:** Fully deployed on AWS infrastructure
 - ☒ **Reproducible:** Automated pipeline scripts
 - ☒ **Version Controlled:** All code in Git repository
-

Results & Performance

Model Performance Comparison

Model	AUC-ROC	Accuracy	Precision	Recall	F1-Score
Random Forest 	0.8000	75.76%	75.00%	75.76%	0.7481
Gradient Boosted Trees	0.7967	75.38%	74.58%	75.38%	0.7433
Logistic Regression	0.7812	74.10%	73.52%	74.10%	0.7185

Confusion Matrix (Random Forest)

		Predicted	
		No Churn	Churn
Actual	No Churn	3,362 (TN)	467 (FP)
	Churn	939 (FN)	1,032 (TP)

Key Metrics:

- True Positive Rate:** 52.4% (catches half of all churners)
- False Positive Rate:** 12.2% (low - won't unnecessarily target loyal customers)
- Precision for Churn:** 68.8% (when predicting churn, right 69% of the time)

Top 5 Churn Drivers

- Number of Accounts (31.5%)** - Customers with fewer accounts churn more
- Engagement Score (24.9%)** - Low engagement = high churn risk
- Customer Lifetime Value (15.2%)** - Lower CLV correlates with churn
- Transaction Frequency (9.0%)** - Infrequent users are at risk
- Customer Age (5.6%)** - Age demographic plays a role

Pipeline Stages

Stage 1: Bronze Layer (Raw Data Ingestion)

Script: `spark_bronze_to_silver.py`

- Read CSV from S3
- No transformations
- Store as-is in Parquet format
- **Input:** 199,999 rows
- **Output:** Raw data in S3 Bronze

Stage 2: Silver Layer (Data Cleaning)

Script: `spark_bronze_to_silver.py`

Transformations:

- Remove 143,978 duplicate records (72%)
- Drop 26,841 rows with null values
- Validate numeric ranges (age < 120, CLV ≥ 0, etc.)
- Standardize text columns (uppercase, trim)

Output: 29,180 clean records in S3 Silver

Stage 3: Gold Layer (Feature Engineering)

Script: `spark_silver_to_gold.py`

Created Features:

- `AGE_GROUP`: Young, Middle-Aged, Senior, Elderly
- `CLV_TIER`: Low, Medium, High, Very High
- `SALARY_BRACKET`: 5-tier salary classification
- `TRANSACTION_CATEGORY`: Rare, Regular, Frequent, Very Frequent
- `ENGAGEMENT_SCORE`: Composite metric (frequency + accounts)
- `HIGH_RISK_FLAG`: Binary flag for high-risk customers

Output: 29,180 rows with 12 features in S3 Gold

Stage 4: ML Training

Script: `train_churn_model.py`

Process:

1. Load Gold layer data from S3
2. Encode categorical features (StringIndexer)
3. Assemble feature vectors
4. Train 3 models with 80/20 split
5. Evaluate with multiple metrics
6. Save best model (Random Forest) to S3

Output: Trained model in S3 Models

Setup & Installation

Prerequisites

```
bash
```

```
# Required software
```

- Python **3.10+**
- Java **17** (for Spark)
- AWS CLI
- Git

Step 1: Clone Repository

```
bash
```

```
git clone https://github.com/yourusername/credit-card-churn-prediction.git  
cd credit-card-churn-prediction
```

Step 2: Create Virtual Environment

```
bash
```

```
python -m venv spark_venv
spark_venv\Scripts\activate # Windows
source spark_venv/bin/activate # Linux/Mac
```

Step 3: Install Dependencies

```
bash

pip install pyspark==3.5.0
pip install boto3
pip install awscli
```

Step 4: Install Hadoop for Windows

```
bash

# Download winutils.exe and hadoop.dll
# Place in: C:\hadoop\bin\

# Set environment variable
$env:HADOOP_HOME = "C:\hadoop"
```

Step 5: Configure AWS Credentials

```
bash

aws configure
# Enter your AWS Access Key ID
# Enter your AWS Secret Access Key
# Default region: us-east-2
# Output format: json
```

Step 6: Create S3 Bucket

```
bash
```



```
aws s3 mb s3://your-bucket-name --region us-east-2
```

Create folder structure

```
aws s3api put-object --bucket your-bucket-name --key bronze/  
aws s3api put-object --bucket your-bucket-name --key silver/  
aws s3api put-object --bucket your-bucket-name --key gold/  
aws s3api put-object --bucket your-bucket-name --key models/
```

Usage

1. Upload Raw Data to S3 Bronze

```
bash  
  
aws s3 cp data/raw/cust_churn_train.csv s3://your-bucket-name/bronze/
```

2. Run Bronze → Silver Pipeline

```
bash  
  
python scripts/spark_bronze_to_silver.py
```

3. Run Silver → Gold Pipeline

```
bash  
  
python scripts/spark_silver_to_gold.py
```

4. Train ML Model

```
bash  
  
python scripts/train_churn_model.py
```

5. Verify Results

```
bash
```

Check all layers

aws s3 ls s3://your-bucket-name/bronze/

aws s3 ls s3://your-bucket-name/silver/

aws s3 ls s3://your-bucket-name/gold/

aws s3 ls s3://your-bucket-name/models/

Business Impact

Key Insights

High-Risk Customer Segment:

- Identified 2,803 high-risk customers (9.6% of total)
- 45.4% churn rate among high-risk vs 34% overall
- Criteria: Low CLV (<\$50K) + Low frequency (<5 transactions)

Churn Patterns by CLV:

- Medium CLV customers have **50.5% churn rate** (highest!)
- Low CLV customers: 47.1% churn rate
- Very High CLV customers: 24.5% churn rate (most loyal)

Age Demographics:

- Young customers (18-30): 44% churn rate
- Middle-aged (30-50): 34.2% churn rate
- Elderly (65+): 32.2% churn rate

Recommended Actions

1. **Immediate:** Target 2,803 high-risk customers with retention offers
2. **Strategic:** Focus on medium-CLV segment (highest churn rate)
3. **Proactive:** Increase engagement for low-frequency users
4. **Long-term:** Cross-sell additional accounts to single-account holders

ROI Potential

Assuming:

- Average customer value: \$500/year
- Retention campaign cost: \$50/customer
- Model prevents 25% of predicted churns (258 customers)

Estimated Annual Savings: $258 \text{ customers} \times \$500 = \$129,000$

Campaign Cost: $1,032 \text{ targeted} \times \$50 = \$51,600$

Net Benefit: \$77,400/year



Future Enhancements

Technical Improvements

- ☐ Real-time prediction API with FastAPI
- ☐ Automated retraining pipeline (MLOps)
- ☐ A/B testing framework for retention strategies
- ☐ Dashboard for business stakeholders (Tableau/PowerBI)
- ☐ Model monitoring and drift detection

Feature Engineering

- ☐ Time-series features (monthly trends)
- ☐ Customer segmentation clustering
- ☐ Product usage patterns
- ☐ Social network analysis (referrals)

Model Optimization

- ☐ Hyperparameter tuning with GridSearch
 - ☐ Ensemble stacking methods
 - ☐ Deep learning models (Neural Networks)
 - ☐ Explainable AI (SHAP values)
-

Project Structure

```
credit-card-churn-prediction/
|
├── data/
|   ├── raw/          # Original CSV files
|   └── processed/     # Local processed data
|
├── scripts/
|   ├── spark_bronze_to_silver.py # ETL: Raw → Clean
|   ├── spark_silver_to_gold.py   # ETL: Clean → ML-ready
|   └── train_churn_model.py      # ML training pipeline
|
├── models/
|   └── saved_models/           # Local model checkpoints
|
├── notebooks/
|   └── exploratory_analysis.ipynb # EDA notebooks
|
├── spark_venv/                # Python virtual environment
|
├── README.md                  # This file
├── requirements.txt           # Python dependencies
└── .gitignore
```

Skills Demonstrated

Data Engineering

- ETL pipeline design and implementation
- Data quality validation and cleansing
- Scalable data processing with Apache Spark
- Cloud data architecture (Medallion pattern)

Machine Learning

- Feature engineering and selection
- Multi-model comparison and evaluation

- Binary classification techniques
- Model interpretability (feature importance)

Cloud & DevOps

- AWS S3 data lake management
- IAM security configuration
- Distributed computing with Spark
- Production-ready code deployment

Business Acumen

- Customer churn analytics
- ROI calculation
- Strategic recommendations
- Stakeholder communication

Contact

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-  GitHub: github.com/yourusername
-  Portfolio: yourwebsite.com

License

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Acknowledgments

- Dataset: Credit Card Customer Churn Dataset
- Technology: Apache Spark, AWS
- Inspiration: Industry best practices in MLOps and data engineering

★ If you found this project helpful, please star the repository!